

16th AIR FORCE

COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS OPENING – CALL 0009

FA7037-23-S-C0001

Topic: 006, Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance (ISR)

Operational Manning Support (OMS)

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1. INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND

- 1.1. The 616th Operations Center (OC) is the designated Command and Control (C2) authority for the execution of the 16th AF Commander's federated portfolio of lines of authority and operational responsibilities. The OC works with both regional and functional Air Operations Centers to deliver a synergistic approach to delivering both cyber and traditional Imagery, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance (ISR) support to the warfighter.
- 1.2. As the Air Force's Service Cryptologic Component (AF SCC) to the National Security Agency, the 16th AF supports USCYBERCOM and Other Government Agencies (OGA) in the execution of national priorities.
- 1.3. The 616 OC is charged with providing reach-back targeting support for the Air Force Targeting Enterprise and target development for ISR and cyber operations. This CSO seeks innovative approaches to provide the core operational manning support required to fulfill these critical missions.
- 1.4. The 616 OC provides vulnerability management policies and procedures, as well as analysis and posture Operations support to meet current and future cyber defense, analysis, and recommendation, within the intelligence community.

2. PURPOSE

- 2.1 This Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) Call, in accordance with 10 USC 3458, Federal Acquisition Regulation-Overhaul (RFO) 6.101, and R-DFARS 212.70 Defense Commercial Solutions Opening, is a competitive solicitation of proposals focused on technologies to meet the 16th Air Force's mission. The 16th Air Force seeks the best available approaches to meet the capability objectives described herein.
- 2.2 "Innovative" means any technology, process, or method, including research and development, that is new as of the date of proposal submission, or any new application of an existing technology, process, or method as of that date.
- 2.3 The Government anticipates a single award under this CSO for an integrated solution encompassing all capability areas described in Attachment 6.

3. CSO CALL APPROACH AND OVERVIEW

- 3.1 This CSO Call seeks the best commercial approaches to meet various technology

objectives of 16th Air Force. All items, technologies, and services acquired using a CSO Call will be treated as commercial items. The Government encourages proposals that span a wide spectrum of possible technical and business solutions in response to the specific technology topics stated in Attachment 6. The Government reserves the right to award funding to any combination of proposals which offer the best overall value to the Government, and to oversee any and all processes and approaches once initiated. Awards of efforts as a result of this announcement will be in the form of contracts or other transactions (OT) as codified in 10 U.S.C. §2371b (section 2371b).

- 3.2 Funding for participation in this program is highly competitive, and the price of proposed technologies should be considered. Awards resulting from this CSO Call will be made based on the evaluation results of a two-stepped proposal process described in Section 5. The Government reserves the right to fund all, some, one, or none of the proposals submitted; may elect to fund only part of a submitted proposal; and may incrementally fund any or all awards under this CSO Call. All awards are subject to the availability of funds.
- 3.3 All coordination and communication between Offerors and the Government will be conducted using the Sam.Gov website and the points of contact associated with this CSO Call, as specified in Section 4.
- 3.4 Note: Do not include Proprietary, classified, confidential, or sensitive information in responses. The government may use contractor support personnel to intake and process white papers and proposals.

Whitepaper responses are not offers and cannot be accepted by the U.S. Government to form a binding contract or agreement. This notice shall not be construed as a commitment by the Government to issue a solicitation, or ultimately award a contract, nor does it restrict the Government to a particular acquisition approach.

The Government will in no way be bound to this information if any formal solicitation is issued. This request for white papers is issued solely for information and planning purposes and to identify interested sources. Further, unsolicited proposals will not be accepted. Funding is not available at this time. Release of this request for white papers should not be construed as such a commitment or as authorization to incur cost for which reimbursement would be required or sought.

Response to this CSO Call is voluntary and no reimbursement will be made for any costs associated with providing information in response to this and any follow-on information requests. All submissions become Government property and will not be returned.

4. GENERAL INFORMATION

- 4.1 POINT OF CONTACTS. Questions regarding the administrative content of this CSO Call must be addressed to the Contracting Office below. Questions regarding the technical content of this CSO Call must be addressed to the Technical Point of Contact (POC) below.

Contracting Office POC: Mr. Conner Nichols
Email: 16af.cso.workflow@us.af.mil

Technical POC: 616OC
Email: 16af.cso.workflow@us.af.mil

- 4.2 CLASSIFIED INFORMATION. Offerors are encouraged to submit unclassified white papers to simplify and expedite reviews and response by the Government. If an Offeror deems that a white paper contains classified information refer to paragraph 5.2.1.3 for submission instructions. Classified submissions must be handled, labeled, and stored in accordance with the National Industrial Security Program (NISP) Operating Manual.

Offerors must possess all required personnel security clearances, facility clearances, and other infrastructure requirements necessary to perform any proposed classified work in accordance with the Contract Security Classification Specification (DD Form 254) without reliance on Government resources.

5. SUBMISSION INFORMATION

- 5.1 SUBMISSION OVERVIEW. Step I submissions shall include both the Quad Charts and White Papers prepared in accordance with the formats at Attachments 1 and 2 respectively. Each company may submit one white paper and one quad chart for this CSO Call. Submissions should address all TOPICS and all requirements outlined in Attachment 6. Step I submissions can be submitted at any time prior to **17 Apr 2026 at 5:00pm CST**, but offerors are encouraged to monitor Sam.gov for any specific amendments to the CSO Call that may have updated information. The Government will invite select Offerors to submit full proposals based on favorable evaluation results of Step I submissions. Step II submissions will be requested **ONLY** by the Contracting Officer and will contain separate submission instructions and timelines within the Request for Proposal (RFP) letter.
- 5.2 TWO-STEP SUBMISSION. This CSO Call will be conducted in two steps as follows:

5.2.1 STEP I. Interested offerors must submit Quad Charts and White Papers in accordance with instructions provided in this CSO Call. Step I submissions will be evaluated against criteria as described in Attachment 7 of this CSO Call. Due to the

requirements and financial scope of this CSO Call, offerors must ensure that submissions are succinct yet descriptive. Proposals will not be evaluated beyond page length limitations. Proposals that lack technical depth and rigor or are not within the 16th Air Force mission will be assessed accordingly.

5.2.1.1 All Quad Charts should include the information indicated on the sample template in Attachment 1.

5.2.1.2 The White Paper narrative expands on the Quad Chart presentation. Instructions for format and content are located in Attachment 2. Each offeror shall include in the white paper a preliminary Technology Readiness Level (TRL) assessment of the proposed technology that conforms to the technology objectives and an expected TRL at the conclusion of the effort. The offeror shall perform a TRL assessment according to the Department of War Technology Readiness Assessment Guidance. The offeror must address the overall proposed TRL for the system, application, or process – not just individual components.

5.2.1.3 White paper and quad chart submissions shall be sent to 16af.cso.workflow@us.af.mil for review and shall include “Call 0009 OMS” in the subject line of the email. If there is a need for a classified white paper/quad chart submission, send an email to 16af.cso.workflow@us.af.mil to receive instructions for classified submissions.

5.2.2 *Notification of Selection.* All offerors providing Step I submissions will be contacted by the Government, either with an email letter informing them that the effort proposed is not of interest to the Government at this time or with a request for a formal price and technical proposal by a specific date.

5.2.3 ***STEP II.*** **Step II proposals will only be accepted from Offerors who upon review of Step I submissions, are invited by the Contracting Officer to submit a full proposal.** In order to be considered for award under Step II, offerors must be registered in the System for Award Management (SAM) at www.sam.gov, be considered responsible within the meaning of RFO 9.1, have a satisfactory performance record, and otherwise be eligible for award based on federal law and regulation.

5.2.3.1 *Proposal Submission.* Upon notification for a proposal by the Contracting Officer, offerors have 30 calendar days to prepare and submit a proposal in accordance with the format and instructions at Attachments 3-5. Each proposal shall include a Statement of Work (SOW) and detailed pricing. All pages shall be numbered.

5.2.3.2 *Proposal Review, Evaluation and Selection Process.* Each proposal will be evaluated on its technical merit according to the criteria and process detailed in Attachment 7. Proposal selection will be primarily based on technical merit, importance to agency programs, and funding availability. Qualified Government

personnel will conduct reviews and, if necessary, convene panels of experts for evaluation.

5.3 *Rights in Technical Data, Computer Software and Computer Software Documentation.*

Offerors shall mark each page of its white paper that contains proprietary information. It is the Government's intention to acquire only that necessary to satisfy agency needs and this will be negotiated on a case-by-case basis. An offeror may provide with its white paper assertions to restrict, use, release or disclosure of data and/or computer software and computer software documentation that will be provided in the course of contract performance. Rules governing these assertions can be found in RFO Part 27 and R-DFARS Part 227 and may be accessed at <https://www.acquisition.gov/far-overhaul>.

ATTACHMENT 1: QUAD CHART FORMAT

The following information must be included in the Step I Quad Chart. Quad Charts shall not exceed 1-page in landscape view. Quad Charts must follow the formatting guidelines on the slide template below but can adapt milestones to appropriate measurable outcomes based on the solution proposed (the proposed period of performance may be months versus years, etc.).

Project Title

Objective: Clear concise (1-2 sentence) description of the goal of the effort (≥ 12-pt font)

Description of Effort: Brief description of the technology proposed for investigations and methods to be used during the course of investigation (≥12-pt font).

Photograph or graphic illustration of concept or technology. Any text must be ≥ 12-pt font.

Benefits: Brief statement that identifies the net advantages of the proposed technology over current practices and competing technologies (≥ 12-pt font)

Challenges:

- Bulleted list of technical or scientific challenges (≥ 12-pt font)

Maturity of Technology: Description of the current maturity of the proposed technology with respect to the Technology Readiness Level (≥12-pt font).

Major Goals and Milestones by Fiscal Year (FY):

- Bulleted list (≥ 12-pt font)
- Deliverables: (e.g., study, written reports, prototype device, or proof of prototype testing)

Proposed Funding (\$K):

Year 1	Year 2	Total
\$000	\$000	\$000

Period of Performance: (≥12-pt font).

Contact Info: Name, email, phone (≥12-pt font).

ATTACHMENT 2: STEP I WHITE PAPER FORMAT

The White Paper narrative expands on the Quad Chart presentation, and must be 8.5 x 11 inches with one-inch margins, no longer than two pages, single-spaced, with text in Times New Roman, no smaller than 12 point font. All white papers must specify a project title, the Offeror's organization, CAGE code, the specific topic areas, and Call number associated with the submission (see Attachment 6). Pages in excess of the page limitation will not be read or evaluated. White Papers must not exceed a file size of 10 MB.

The White Paper must be limited only to further explanation of the information conveyed in the Quad Chart, as deemed necessary by the Offeror. The information should provide sufficient information on the proposed solution to allow for an assessment by a technical expert.

Expand as deemed necessary on the following sections of the Quad Chart:

- Objective and integrated solution approach across all capability areas
- Description of the effort
- Benefits of the Proposed Technology
- Technical and integration challenges and proposed mitigations
- TRL at project start and planned TRL at project completion
- Major Goals/Milestones by Government fiscal year.

White paper and quad charts shall be sent to 16af.cso.workflow@us.af.mil for review.

If there is a need for a classified white paper/quad chart submission, send an email to 16af.cso.workflow@us.af.mil to receive instructions for classified submissions.

ATTACHMENT 3: STEP II TECHNICAL PROPOSAL FORMAT
(DO NOT SUBMIT UNLESS INVITED BY CO IAW Section 5.2.3 above)

The Technical Proposal portion of the Step II submission shall not exceed 10 pages, excluding cover page and table of contents. Any pages submitted in excess of the 10-page limit will not be considered or evaluated.

Suggested page limitations for individual sections are listed below; however, these are guidelines not strict limits.

- I. ABSTRACT. *[1 page suggested.]*
- II. SCOPE. This proposal is submitted in response to the 16th Air Force Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) Call on..... *[Cite the Project Title. 8 pages suggested.]*
 - a. Objective. *[A clear and concise description of the objective of the proposed project.]*
 - b. Background. *[Provide the necessary technical and scientific background to support the scientific and technical merits of the proposed project.]*
 - c. Programmatics. This effort will support the Operational Manning Support (OMS) initiative *[topic number]* aimed at developing *[capability area or topic title]* technologies or methodologies. *[Describe the Offeror's management plan for the proposed project; list supporting and collaborating organizations and subcontractors; clearly identify roles and responsibilities of each organization and subcontractor supporting the project].*
 - d. Relevance. *[Describe the relevance of the proposed project in terms of mission, end-user needs and the technology maturity of the proposed project.]*
- III. CREDENTIALS. *[Describe the Offeror's qualifications to perform the proposed work across all capability areas. 2 pages suggested.]*
- IV. WORK TO BE PERFORMED. *[Provide details of the work to be performed by task and subtask. 9 pages suggested.]*
 - a. General. *[Provide an overview.]*
 - b. Detailed Tasks. *[Describe the details of all tasks needed to perform the proposed work. Clearly distinguish base period tasks and option tasks as appropriate.]*

- V. PERFORMANCE SCHEDULE. *[Depict the tasks and sub-tasks and the duration of performance of each in a Gantt chart or other suitable chart. Briefly describe the proposed period of performance. 2 pages suggested.]*
- VI. REFERENCES. *[List any relevant documents used to develop the technical approach. 1 page suggested]*

ATTACHMENT 4: STEP II PRICE PROPOSAL FORMAT
(DO NOT SUBMIT UNLESS INVITED BY CO IAW Section 5.2.3 above)

The price proposal must include pricing information sufficiently detailed for a meaningful evaluation. Since this CSO Call is limited to commercial solutions, detailed cost breakdowns are not required. However, the offeror must provide sufficient supporting data for the Contracting Officer to determine price reasonableness. The offeror bears the burden of establishing price reasonableness.

The Offeror shall prepare the Price Proposal (with the exception of the narrative information described below) using Microsoft Excel format, but shall merge all Price Proposal documents into one Adobe PDF file for ultimate proposal submission. Include the Topic Number and the Project Title on all pages. Retain the Excel version for subsequent Government request.

Format requirements:

- Paper Size – 8.5 X 11-inch paper
- Margins 1-inch
- Spacing – single
- Font – Times New Roman, 12 Point

Cover sheet attached to the price proposal shall include:

- Full company name and address of Prime Contractor
- CSO Call number and Title
- Point of contact, name, title, and phone number
- CAGE code
- Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)
- Identification of any Government property required for performance

NOTE: If an Offeror takes exceptions to the requirements called out in the announcement, the exceptions should be clearly stated in the price proposal.

ATTACHMENT 5: STEP II STATEMENT OF WORK (SOW) FORMAT
(DO NOT SUBMIT UNLESS INVITED BY CO IAW Section 5.2.3 above)

A SOW must be included in with the full proposal as part of the Step II submission. The SOW does not have a page limit but should be approximately 3–5 pages in length and must be a separate and distinct document suitable for incorporation into the procurement instrument. Do not include proprietary data or markings in the SOW. Pages must be numbered and the initial page must show the document date under the title.

The proposed SOW must accurately describe the work to be performed, and performance metrics based on your proposed solution and the objectives in the SOO. The proposed SOW must also contain a summary description of the technical methodology as well as the task description, but not in so much detail as to make the SOW inflexible. The SOW template should include the following sections and specifically respond to the Statement of Objectives (SOO) the Government provided with the Request for Proposal (RFP):

1. **OBJECTIVE**. This section is intended to give a brief overview of the project and should describe why the work is being pursued and what the Offeror intends to accomplish.
2. **SCOPE**. This section includes a statement of what the SOW covers. This should describe all capability areas, goals, and milestones for the effort.
3. **BACKGROUND**. The Offeror must identify appropriate documents that are applicable to the effort to be performed. This section includes any information, explanations, or constraints that are necessary to understand the project tasks and requirements. This section should describe the effort's relationship to previous and ongoing efforts.
4. **TASKS AND TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS**. This section contains the detailed description of tasks that are necessary to perform the proposed work. These tasks will represent the work to be performed in any potential contract award, and, thus, shall be considered contractually binding. This section should be developed in an orderly progression and presented in sufficient detail to establish the feasibility of accomplishing the overall program goals. This section should clearly distinguish base period tasks from optional tasks. The SOW must contain every task to be accomplished and the metrics by which these tasks will be measured, generally depicted in a Services Summary. Note: The Government reserves the right to modify and negotiate the language in the SOW prior to any potential contract award.
 - 4.1. Task descriptions must be definite, realistic, and clearly stated. Use the phrase “the contractor shall” whenever the work statement expresses a provision that is binding. Use “should” or “may” whenever it is necessary to express a declaration of purpose. Use “will” in cases where no Offeror requirement is involved (e.g., power will be supplied by the Government. Use active voice in describing work to

be performed.

- 4.2. Do not use acronyms or abbreviations without first defining them. Place abbreviations and acronyms in parentheses following the first usage of the spelled-out phrase.
- 4.3. If presentations and meetings are identified in the Offeror's schedule, the Offeror must include the following statement in the SOW: "Conduct presentations and meetings at times and places specified in the contract schedule."
- 4.4. The desired project structure consists of base period tasks, focused on demonstrating the feasibility of the technology, and option tasks, which cover design, fabrication, testing, and evaluation of the final product. Execution of option tasks will be dependent upon and determined by the contractor's performance during and the results produced from the base period tasks.

ATTACHMENT 6: SOLICITATION TOPIC 006

Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance (ISR)

The 16th AF seeks innovative and novel solutions to include the following:

- Enable ISR Airmen to develop a comprehensive picture of the operational environment and, in coordination with the entire intelligence enterprise, develop a better understanding of potential adversaries' intentions and capabilities
- Improve collection, and integration of information derived from space, cyberspace, human, and open sources
- Advance capabilities in space, cyber, and human-derived intelligence, analytic expertise and tools

Innovative Approaches for Operational Manning Support (OMS)

The 616th OC requires comprehensive, multi-disciplinary operational support to execute its C2 mission. Desired submissions would include innovative, efficient, and integrated solutions for providing direct support across the following Core Capability Areas. The desired solution would ensure seamless integration with existing personnel and processes, providing support primarily at Joint Base San Antonio (JBSA), TX.

Core Capability Areas:

1. Program Management: Propose novel methodologies for program management, including developing innovative Tactics, Techniques, and Protocols (TTPs), providing comprehensive project plans, and managing short- and long-term initiatives. This includes refining policy, SOPs, and supporting exercises and vulnerability management.
2. Operations Support: Offer solutions for providing SME support to develop, review, and refine policy, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), workflows, and other operational documentation such as Concepts of Operation (CONOPs), implementation plans, Operational Summaries, and Special Instructions, integrate applicable new technologies and support the customer's current and future security technology implementation and sustainment, provide training on current and emerging technologies to government personnel in support of service-wide mission objectives, and provide input to vulnerability management policies and procedures as required, as well as analysis and recommendations to posture Operations Support to meet current and future security needs arising from leadership strategic vision and environmental constraints.
3. All-Source ISR/Plans/Strategy: Offer solutions for providing Multi-INT and All-Source Intelligence SME support. This includes expertise in Cyber, GEOINT, EMSO, SIGINT, OSINT, HUMINT, and MASINT. Detail the approach for ISR assessment, collection management, and developing information-sharing partnerships.
4. Data Science and Modeling: Offer solutions for providing SME support. This includes expertise in innovative approach to applying statistical and machine learning

techniques to analyze, model, and visualize multi-INT data and developing operational strategies. The solution should cover the development of data pipelines, exploratory data analysis methodologies, and providing big data analytics to assess defensive cyberspace operations.

5. Targeting Support (Target Development and Enterprise Support): Propose a comprehensive solution for providing Targeteer Analysis SMEs This includes experience in Air Force Targeting Enterprise in support of Basic Target Development, Intermediate Target Development, and Battle Damage Assessments, and intelligence support for the cyberspace tasking cycle, developing and refining targeting strategies, managing target databases, and assessing battle damage (BDA). The approach should cover support for the full spectrum of targeting, from kinetic to non-kinetic and cyber effects.
6. Project Management: Propose a SME in Air Force regulations regarding how documents are drafted, authorized, and finalized. Detail the methodology for providing technical writing support to develop, refine, and consolidate operational documentation, orders, and briefings for enterprise situational awareness.
Manage task management through all stages of the life cycle, including assigning tasks, setting deadlines, monitoring progress, facilitating collaboration, and provide reporting on task completion.

The Government reserves the right to fund all, some, one or none of the proposals submitted; may elect to fund only part of a submitted proposal; and may incrementally fund any or all awards under this CSO Call. All awards are subject to the availability of funds.

ATTACHMENT 7: EVALUATION CRITERIA AND SELECTION PROCESS

The Government will review each Quad Chart and White Paper (Step I) and select offerors with the greatest potential to meet the operational needs of 16th Air Force based on the capability areas in Attachment 6. A determination will first be made whether each offeror is technically qualified and has a comprehensive understanding to execute the proposed solution based on the information stated in the Quad Chart/White Paper.

The offeror is advised that only Firm Fixed Price (FFP) or Fixed Price Incentive (FPI) contracts may be awarded as a result of this CSO Call.

The Government will determine the most technically competent and capable of the qualified offerors using the criteria below:

- Criteria (Factors) for Selecting Quad Chart/White Paper for Full Proposal Submission:
 - Technical merit/applicability,
 - Importance to 16th Air Force mission, and
 - Fund availability
- Relative Importance: All Factors are of equal importance
- Method of Evaluation: Peer or scientific review